

Katharina (Qiao-Yun) Cheng

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Informatics, Concentration: Data Science

Seattle, WA

University of Washington

June 2026

Annual Dean's List (2022 – 2025)

Cumulative GPA: 3.81/ 4.0

Relevant Coursework: Databases & Data Modeling | Database Design & Management | Advanced Methods in Data Science | Introduction to Search & Recommendation Systems | Introduction to Machine Learning | Introduction to Artificial Intelligence | Text Mining | Client-Side Development | Server-Side Development | IOS Mobile Development

SKILLS

Technical: R, Python, Java, SQL, HTML, CSS, D3, JavaScript, Swift, Tableau, Figma, DevOps, Azure, MongoDB

Languages: Bilingual (Mandarin, English)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

Seattle, WA

University of Washington, iSchool

Sep 2024 - Jun 2025

- Conduct lab sessions for INFO 103, facilitate discussions on social media history, privacy, consent, and free speech
- Grade assignments and provide feedback to students on their performance, ensuring clarity and accuracy
- Support students applying concepts to automation projects like Bluesky, Reddit, or Discord bot

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Seattle, WA

Social Media Algorithms (X Community Notes)

Sep 2025 - now

- Analyzed large-scale CN data to compare latent factor/intercept behavior across modeling groups
- Built interpretation pipeline for latent representations & iterative experiments to balance interpretability & overfitting
- Implemented LLM-assisted cluster/factor annotation with controlled positive/negative examples and repeated runs to assess stability; validated labels via manual “smell-check”

RELATIVE EXPERIENCE

Project Lead & Full-Stack Developer

Seattle, WA

Study Buddy

Oct 2025 - Dec 2025

- Led a 4-person team to deliver a production-style web app with authentication, profiles, and an invitation/matching workflow; owned system architecture, schema, and API documentation
- Built core UI flows and implemented session middleware to reliably resolve current-user identity across requests
- Co-built real-time chat by WebSockets + database-backed history, enabling persistent conversations between users
- Drove engineering execution via sprint planning, debugging support, and task coordination to keep delivery on track

Data Engineer(Web Scraping & MongoDB)

Seattle, WA

GameLensDB(NoSQL Video Game Metadata & Trends)

May 2025 - Jun 2025

- Scraped MobyGames with Selenium + BeautifulSoup, exporting JSON and loading 1,100+ titles into MongoDB
- Standardized 8 key attributes across 1.1k+ MongoDB docs, improving filterability and downstream analyses
- Designed aggregation pipelines to surface genre/platform trends, developer/publisher activity, and score vs. business model, packaged into concise takeaways

Front-End Developer

Seattle, WA

Weather Visualization Dashboard

Feb 2025 - Mar 2025

- Developed an interactive weather trends dashboard using D3.js and JavaScript, enabling users to compare daily or monthly average temperatures between global cities from 2014 to 2015
- Integrated dropdown menus and responsive charts for dynamic data filtering and enhanced user interactivity
- Cleaned and transformed raw historical weather data from Weather Underground

Platform Search and Recommendation System Designer & Front-End Developer

Seattle, WA

Recipe Finder: Recipe Discovery and Recommendation

Nov 2024 - Dec 2024

- Designed a platform with information retrieval capabilities, leveraging information crawled from the internet
- Utilize a mapping function to suggest related queries and improve user experience over time
- Integrated PyTerrier and the BM25 ranking model to ensure efficient and relevant recipe retrieval